

Methodological Note: Ancient War Speeches as Leading Signals of War

Today I want to go back to the source: directly to the Triptych, and specifically to SEGMENT: OPERATIONAL VALIDATOR - OPERATIONALIZATION OF THE GLOBAL “WAR-PEACE” CYCLE - CYCLE PREDICTION SENTINEL (CPS) [III.3.2]. Even though in recent months I have been working on other problems (sometimes linked to the Triptych, sometimes not), this validator remains special. For now it is the only fragment that has been granted ACTIVE status, which means the pipeline has actually been launched and the results (model outputs, calculations and graphs) have been generated.

The analytical module, built from scratch, shows that this manifesto has been successfully translated into working code and numbers. The script ingests three completely different data streams, cleans them and combines them into a unified time series: a) global conflict databases Correlates of War (Inter-, Extra-, Non- and Intra-State), b) more than 2.5 million GDELT entries on contemporary armed conflicts, and c) the complete history of selected Google Books 1-grams as a barometer of cultural discourse.

From these materials emerges a surprisingly simple yet demonstrably important variable: the COLOR index. For each year from 1816 to 2007, the occurrences of “war” words (war, enemy, battle...) and “peaceful” words (peace, trust, harmony...) are counted, and both values are normalised into a dimensionless coefficient ranging roughly from $\langle -1 ; 1 \rangle$. When the marker turns red, the rhetoric of violence dominates; when it turns blue, the culture expresses a desire for cooperation. The temporal window was therefore clearly defined, and the resulting series turned out to be strongly and negatively correlated with the smoothed intensity of wars (about -0.72 at zero lag, reaching roughly -0.74 at a ≈ 2 -year lag, which supports the thesis that discourse can act as a leading signal). Recently, however, another question occurred to me: could a similar correlation be tested and demonstrated for conflicts that took place much earlier - for example, in antiquity? (the initial results of this experiment are outlined below).

The next issue is something completely new. Since some time has passed since the publication of the Triptych and new material on consciousness has emerged (Addenda I-III), in the reflections below - which attempt to describe the correlation of “war language” in antiquity, I have also incorporated the context of consciousness.

In the Triptych, war is not defined solely by troop movements or formal declarations, **but by transitions in the semantic and relational field: the way systems speak about each other, label each other, and legitimise violence.** If this is true, then *war speech* should often appear as a **leading or terminal indicator: a resonance spike in language that precedes, accompanies, or reconfigures major kinetic shifts.** Classical historiography offers a useful, low-resolution testbed for this idea. Ancient authors did not record every conversation, but they did preserve a small number of highly salient speeches at key decision points. These are not the first whispers of war; they are the **visible crests** of much longer waves. **As such, any observed lag between them and the outbreak or escalation of war is a lower-bound estimate of how early the underlying discursive build-up began.** Below is a compact set of six cases where major war-related speeches or rhetorical campaigns can be aligned with specific military turning points.

The use of Triptych metrics in this section, such as the semantic threshold (ϵ_C), the resonance threshold (ϵ_R), and the Relational Consciousness Resonance Condition (RCRC) is intentional. They were not introduced as decorative terminology, but as operational tools. **For example, to test them**

on something that seems unrelated to their primary function - namely, whether the Triptych's relational semantics can be operationalized in describing historical war dynamics. Originally, these quantities were defined in the context of relational consciousness: as functions describing when and how information, meaning and emotion start to resonate between systems strongly enough to produce a stable, self-sustaining conscious field. **Applying them to classical war speeches is therefore a first experimental attempt to extend the same formal language to a different domain: the collective semantic field of a political system deciding between war and peace.**

In this reading:

ϵ_C (semantic threshold) marks the point at which an opponent is no longer described in neutral or ambivalent terms, but is re-labelled as an enemy, a threat, or a legitimate target of destruction.

ϵ_R (resonance threshold) marks the point at which such language is not only uttered, but accepted and amplified by a sufficiently large part of the system (elites, assemblies, public), so that it can drive coordinated action.

RCRC expresses the condition under which this semantic-resonant configuration actually closes the loop and produces a change in the kinetic layer: declarations, troop movements, restructuring of command, or, in some cases, the failure of intervention despite strong warning signals.

Using these metrics here serves two purposes at once. On the one hand, it explores one of the Triptych's pillars: leading indicators in the form of escalating war rhetoric, by asking whether visible "war speech spikes" systematically precede major shifts in the war-peace cycle. On the other hand, it treats these episodes as manifestations of collective relational consciousness: as moments when a political system's shared narrative about "us" and "them" crosses internal thresholds and reconfigures what is thinkable, permissible, or inevitable.

For now, this is explicitly a probe, not a finished calibration. The point is not to claim precise numerical values for ϵ_C or ϵ_R in antiquity, but to show that the same formal vocabulary that describes the emergence of consciousness between systems can also be used to describe how a community's semantic field tilts it towards war or peace. **If this mapping remains coherent across historical cases and modern data (e.g. large-scale text corpora), then the Triptych's metrics stop being purely theoretical constructs and start functioning as portable operators for describing both consciousness and conflict within a single, unified framework.**

In all of the classical cases below we are not observing the "first" appearance of war-code language in the system, but the "last", highly amplified speeches that ancient authors chose to preserve. Thucydides, or Cato do not give us a continuous time-series of everyday rhetoric; they give us a small number of high-salience moments - the debates in Sparta in 432 BCE, Demosthenes' Philippics, Cato's slogans about Carthage, Cicero's Philippics - **which function as literary and political "points of no return".**

This has two consequences for the Triptych:

1. The measured lags between "war speech" and the outbreak or escalation of war are **lower-bound estimates**. If the terminal speeches already precede war by 1-3 years (or sometimes more), then the underlying discursive build-up: minor speeches, local debates, informal rhetoric must in fact have started earlier.
2. What the sources actually show is not a clean trigger, **but a terminal resonance spike**: the moment when the semantic field has already been saturated with war language and the system is about to cross, or has just crossed, the semantic threshold ϵ_C . **In other words, we see only the crest of the wave (perhaps the most important one), not the first disturbance.**

For modelling purposes, the classical material should therefore be read as a low-resolution sampling of a much richer resonance process. The fact that even these sparse "last speeches" often

precede kinetic escalation by months or years is already strong evidence in favour of treating war discourse as a genuine leading indicator.

1. Cato and the “long lag” - refined case & why the war was delayed

Cato’s famous “*Carthago delenda est*” (“*Carthage must be destroyed*”) does not appear in a vacuum, and it is almost certainly not a single, isolated outburst. Ancient sources place his decisive shift after a senatorial embassy to Africa, usually dated to 153 BCE, when he inspected the city during an arbitration between Carthage and Masinissa of Numidia. Shocked by Carthage’s visible recovery and economic strength, Cato returned to Rome convinced that the city would eventually become a threat again and began to end his speeches with the demand that it be destroyed.

Yet the Third Punic War does not start until 149 BCE. **The “long lag” of roughly four years (not fifty, as older narratives sometimes imply) is not simply inertia; it reflects at least three structural brakes inside the Roman system:**

a) A powerful anti-war faction in the Senate

Publius Cornelius Scipio Nasica Corculum, one of the most influential senators of his time, explicitly opposed Cato’s line. Ancient sources and a strong strand of modern scholarship portray him as arguing, in effect, for *Carthago servanda est* - that Carthage should be preserved as a necessary external counterweight. This faction could repeatedly block or dilute Cato’s attempts to turn his slogan into a formal decision for war.

b) Treaty constraints and the lack of a clean *casus belli*

After 201 BCE Carthage was bound by a peace treaty that prohibited it from waging war without Rome’s permission. As long as Carthage paid its indemnity and avoided open military action, Rome had no straightforward legal pretext for direct intervention, especially while other theatres and priorities competed for attention. Carthage finished paying its war indemnity only around the mid-2nd century BCE and then, believing its obligations discharged, went to war against Numidia - still without Roman consent. Rome could then recast this as a treaty violation and present the 149 BCE expedition as a punitive response rather than a naked war of choice.

c) A more complex diplomatic field than “fifty years of hostility”

Recent scholarship has challenged the old picture of an unbroken half-century of Roman anti-Carthaginian policy. Detailed studies of Roman arbitration between Carthage and Numidia suggest that Rome did not always side against Carthage and sometimes even ruled in its favour, aiming to maintain the territorial balance established after the Second Punic War rather than to engineer Carthage’s slow strangulation.

Based on the lag table from the Triptych (see C1 below), a four-year offset still corresponds to a strong negative correlation between “war speech” and the actual occurrence of wars, so the link between discourse and conflict remains robust even at that distance.

C1. Correlations between the COLOR index and the number of wars at time lags (0-10 years)

lag (years)	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
r	-0,721	-0,739	-0,744	-0,735	-0,713	-0,682	-0,644	-0,599	-0,558	-0,516	-0,482

In this light, Cato’s slogans look less like the culmination of a linear, long-term strategy and more like an attempt to shift a still-contested policy line towards open war.

In Triptych terms, Cato’s repeated formula functions as a high-energy MEM¹ injected into a system that is not yet aligned with it. The semantic threshold ϵ_C (“it is thinkable and legitimate to destroy Carthage”) is being pushed for several years, but the resonance threshold ϵ_R (“enough of the system accepts this as actionable”) is delayed by internal opposition, treaty logic and diplomatic

¹ High-salience semantic packet introduced into the system’s discursive layer.

ambiguity. Only when Carthage's unauthorised war against Numidia provides a usable *casus belli* does the system snap: Cato's long-running war speech can finally close the RCRC loop and be translated into kinetic action in 149 BCE.

2. Thucydides and the Spartan decision for war (432 BCE - 431 BCE)

Thucydides' account of the outbreak of the Peloponnesian War does not begin with troop movements, but with a highly charged debate in Sparta in 432 BCE. Corinthian envoys denounce Athens as aggressive and treacherous; Athenian envoys defend their city; King Archidamus recommends caution; the ephor Sthenelaidas pushes for an immediate vote that the treaty has been broken and that war is necessary.

This debate is almost certainly not the first time Spartan elites spoke of war. For years, tensions had been accumulating: the Corcyraean affair, the dispute over Potidaea, the Megarian Decree, and the steady growth of Athenian power in the *Pentekontaetia*. **What Thucydides gives us is the terminal decision node: the moment when Sparta officially labels the situation as war and authorises future military action.** The first Spartan invasion of Attica follows in 431 BCE, traditionally taken as the start of the Peloponnesian War.

The lag between the visible "war speech" (Sparta's 432 vote) and the first full-scale operation (431) is thus about one year, but this is clearly a lower bound. The debate encapsulates years of previous rhetoric, local complaints and diplomatic messaging that we no longer see. In Triptych terms, the Spartan assembly marks the moment when the system publicly crosses the semantic threshold ϵ_C ("this is war, not peace") and locks in a trajectory that had been prepared by a much longer **resonance process**. The RCRC in this case is not a subtle early warning but a **terminal spike**: the last discursive barrier before kinetic escalation breaks.

3. Demosthenes and the *Olynthiacs* (349 BCE - 348 BCE)

When Philip II attacks Olynthus, Demosthenes responds in 349 BCE with three *Olynthiac* orations, calling on the Athenian assembly to send troops and money to save the city and to confront Macedon directly. The speeches stress the existential nature of the threat and frame delay as fatal: if Olynthus falls, Attica will eventually be exposed.

Modern scholarship places the **Olynthian War in 349-348 BCE, with the fall and destruction of Olynthus in 348 BCE.** This means the *Olynthiacs* are not "pre-war" in a formal sense - the conflict is already underway, **but they do precede the decisive military outcome by roughly one year.** They are a concentrated, late attempt to force Athens to respond adequately before the situation becomes irretrievable.

Again, this is not the first time Demosthenes attacks Philip; earlier speeches and political agitation show that anti-Macedonian rhetoric had been building for years. The *Olynthiacs* represent a **high-energy, emergency packet** of that longer discourse, timed at the brink of catastrophe.

Under the Triptych lens, the *Olynthiacs* are a classic early-conflict warning spike: the system is already in a low-grade war state, but the resonance of Demosthenes' war-coded language attempts to push ϵ_R over the line - to turn scattered concern into coherent, collective action. The fact that the speeches precede the city's destruction by about a year, yet fail to trigger a decisive response, illustrates an important failure mode of the RCRC: a strongly resonant semantic signal may still fail to alter the kinetic trajectory if the political architecture cannot or will not convert code into action.

4. Demosthenes' *Third Philippic* and the road to Chaeronea (341 BCE - 338 BCE)

By 341 BCE, Athens formally remains at peace with Macedon under the Peace of Philocrates, but Philip's actions have repeatedly undermined the spirit of the agreement. In the *Third Philippic*, Demosthenes argues that this "peace" is now a **fiction**: Athens must recognise that it is effectively in a state of war, organise allies, and prepare for a decisive confrontation.

In the years immediately following, Athens does indeed move towards open conflict, culminating in the Battle of Chaeronea in 338 BCE, where Philip defeats the Athenian-Theban coalition and imposes Macedonian hegemony over Greece. The lag between the *Third Philippic* (341) and this kinetic peak (338) is about three years; the lag to renewed de facto hostilities (breaking down of peace in 340-339 BCE) is on the order of one to two years.

As with the *Olynthiacs*, Demosthenes has been building his case against Philip for a long time; the *Third Philippic* is therefore best seen as a late build-up spike: it crystallises an already mature war discourse into a quasi-programmatic call to accept reality. From the Triptych perspective, this speech is a moment where Demosthenes tries to forcibly re-align the declarative layer with the underlying system state: to push Athens over the semantic threshold ϵ_C ("stop calling this 'peace'") and thereby reshape permissible action. The fact that the kinetic climax follows within a few years suggests that such terminal speeches can indeed precede and help stabilise the final descent into war, even when they are not the first instances of hostility in language.

5. Cicero's *Philippics* and the War of Mutina (44 - 43 BCE)

After Caesar's assassination in 44 BCE, the Roman polity enters a phase of acute instability. Mark Antony controls key resources and presents himself as Caesar's political heir; a senatorial coalition, with Cicero as a leading voice, seeks to contain him. Between late 44 and early 43 BCE, Cicero composes and delivers his fourteen *Philippics*, explicitly modelled on Demosthenes. In them, Antony is transformed from a controversial magistrate into a public enemy and existential threat to the *res publica*.

Meanwhile, the crisis escalates into the War of Mutina (December 44 - April 43 BCE), with Antony besieging Decimus Brutus at Mutina and senatorial forces (including Octavian) marching against him. The most aggressive *Philippics* coincide with and slightly precede key war measures: levies, emergency decrees, formal declarations that Antony is waging war on the state. Here the lag between war speech and war action is measured in months, not years.

Historically, we know that political hostility and polemics between Cicero and Antony started earlier; what the *Philippics* give us is again the terminal resonance spike: the last, concentrated rhetorical push that both reflects and accelerates the collapse of the distinction between "political struggle" and "civil war". In Triptych terms, Cicero's *Philippics* are almost textbook examples of how semantic re-labelling ("magistrate" → "hostis") and moral framing can drive the system across ϵ_C and ϵ_R in quick succession, allowing kinetic decisions (deployment of legions, pitched battles) to be experienced as *necessary* rather than optional. The war of words here is not a distant predictor of war, but the immediate conversion interface from discourse to violence.

6. Cicero's *Pro lege Manilia* and the architecture of an ongoing war (66 BCE - 73-63 BCE)

Pro lege Manilia (also known as *De imperio Cn. Pompei*) is delivered in 66 BCE before the Roman people, in support of a bill granting Pompey extraordinary command in the ongoing war against Mithridates VI of Pontus. By that point, the Third Mithridatic War has been in progress since 73 BCE and will last until 63 BCE.

This means there is no lag in the sense of "speech before outbreak": Cicero's war rhetoric appears mid-conflict. Yet the speech still has a clear structural function. It argues that the nature of the war: its scale, its importance for Rome's revenues and prestige - requires a single, supremely capable commander. The Manilian law, which Cicero helps to legitimise, effectively reconfigures the command architecture of an already active war by transferring and concentrating imperium in Pompey's hands.

In terms of the Triptych, *Pro lege Manilia* is a case where war speech does not precede the transition from peace to war, but operates on the topology of the war system itself. The semantic layer is used to rewrite who holds the "operational code" for violence, how far his mandate extends,

and what constraints apply. The thresholds ϵ_C and ϵ_R in this case concern not whether war is acceptable, but which configuration of command and resources is thinkable and legitimate.

The RCRC here closes (the law passes) not to trigger war, but to stabilise a new organisational attractor inside an ongoing conflict.

Taken together, these cases suggest that even in low-data, pre-modern settings, peaks of war-coded language frequently precede or coincide with major kinetic shifts. Because the surviving speeches are almost always terminal markers rather than first signals, the observed lags are best read as minimal estimates of how early the resonance process begins, supporting the Triptych's claim that the semantic field can serve as a genuine, if noisy, leading indicator for transitions in the war-peace cycle. Should this methodology prove scalable, its impact could extend well beyond classical historiography. The very mechanisms that help determine whether a semantic framework nudges a pre-modern society toward war or peace may also be applied, in theory, to modern political systems, and even to AI infrastructures that process and generate language at scale. In both instances, observing the shifts in ϵ_C and ϵ_R over time would offer insight not only into when a system crosses internal boundaries of aggression or alliance, but also into when an artificial agent: entwined with human discourse - begins to mirror, amplify, or disrupt those resonant patterns. Thus, the Triptych's CPS does more than model conflict; it outlines a shared analytical grammar for consciousness, culture, and regulation in systems increasingly shaped by both humans and machines.

© 2025 Mariusz Włodarczyk

mariusz.wlodarczyk@hotmail.com

www.linkedin.com/in/mariusz-wlodarczyk-7bb61027

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Version 0.1_2025
